

Robots Meet Arts Newsletter #4

June 2025



Robots Meet Arts Tools and Contents: An Update on Our Progress

After months of collaborative work, the Robots Meet Arts project is progressing steadily, focusing on two complementary tools for teachers and students across Europe:

🎓 The **Training Programme for primary school teachers** has been finalised 🎨 and is currently under review by **16 experts**, selected for their complementary expertise in **computational thinking, pedagogy, coding & robotics**, and **inclusivity**. It will be available on a dedicated Moodle platform, to be launched **by the start of the new school year**, offering teachers a comprehensive guide to integrating computational thinking into humanities subjects.

👤 In parallel, the **Robots Meet Arts Curriculum** is ready to inspire classroom practice. It brings together a collection of **lesson plans** connecting **computational thinking with humanities subjects** — mother tongue, history, arts, geography, civics, foreign languages, and music. Currently under review, it will be available by September **in all the project languages**: English, French, Greek, Spanish, and Dutch.

A Taste of the Robots Meet Arts Curriculum

🌐 **Mission Time Travellers** – Create interactive stories in Scratch to explore key moments in European history. Learn about sequences, events, and loops while reflecting on diversity and shared roots.



🎨 **Let's Code Art** – Explore binary code using LEGO Dots to create pixel-like patterns through hands-on crafting. Learn how code structures can support creativity and design.

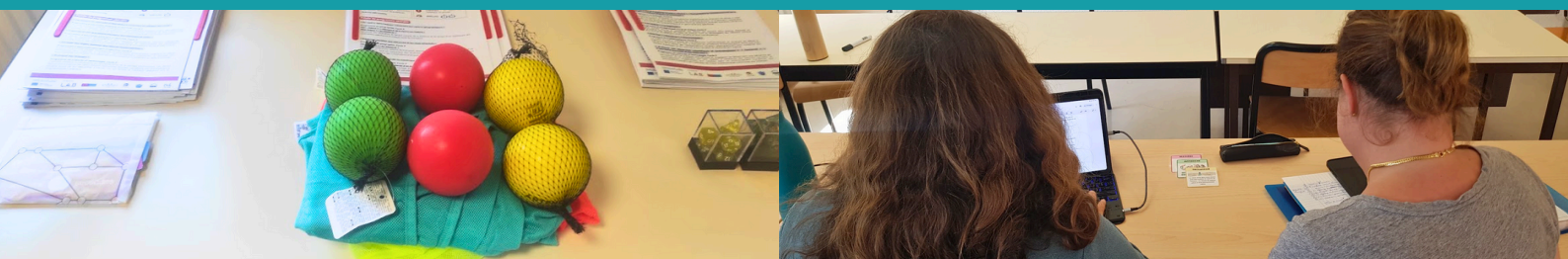


🏛️ **What Would You Change in Ancient Rome?** – Learn about Roman social classes, match roles with privileges, and programme a Tale-Bot to explore historical scenarios.



🌐 **Pass the Parcel** – Use body movement to learn how routing algorithms support internet communication by drawing parallels to real-world networks and transportation modes.





Spotlight on France: Testing the Training Programme

In France, **22 pre-service primary school teachers** 🧑🏫 took part in a pilot training exploring **how computational thinking (CT) can enhance humanities teaching**.

The course, delivered over **8 sessions** in 6 half-days, provided a hands-on introduction to the Robots Meet Arts approach. Each session focused on **linking CT concepts to creative, inclusive, and cross-disciplinary learning**.

- The training began with an **icebreaker** — breaking down a daily routine into steps — to illustrate **decomposition** and set the tone. This was followed by an **introduction to CT's core principles**: *decomposition, pattern recognition, abstraction, and algorithms*.
- Building on these foundations, teachers explored **coding concepts through Dance Your Block!** — an unplugged activity where they created and tested **Scratch block choreographies**, discovering sequencing, precision, and debugging. It showed how coding can be concrete, collaborative, and engaging, even without technology.
- Once familiar with CT through unplugged activities, teachers connected it to humanities with **Narrative Maze**, designing branching storylines using **if...then...** logic. This highlighted how conditional thinking supports creativity in literature, history, and language learning.
- The next session, **Pass the Parcel**, focused on **algorithmic thinking through movement**. Teachers simulated data packet routing by passing balls, experiencing how rules, strategies, and feedback loops shape networks — an active, embodied way to grasp abstract concepts.
- With these experiences, teachers designed **their own CT-integrated humanities lessons**. Ideas included **slam poetry** 🗣️, **historical timelines** 📅, **art description games** 🎨, and **urban planning debates** 🏙️ — all blending CT principles with creativity.
- They also reflected on **inclusion**, revisiting their lessons to **consider diverse learning needs** and discussing ways to make activities more accessible and equitable.
- The final session encouraged teachers to **reflect on how to apply CT practically in their classrooms**, embedding it beyond the training itself.

Through these sessions, participants explored **the full range of modules from the Robots Meet Arts Training Programme**, testing each approach in a collaborative, practical way. This pilot demonstrated that CT can become a **valuable, accessible, and inspiring tool** for teaching humanities in primary education.

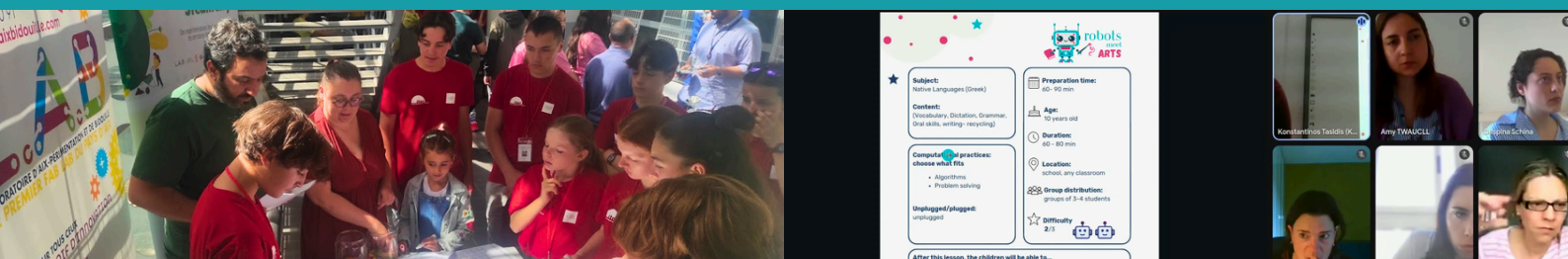
Similar training programmes will soon take place in **Greece, Spain, and Belgium**, allowing teachers there to experience the Robots Meet Arts approach and adapt it to their own classrooms.

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Project website: robots-meet-arts.eu/

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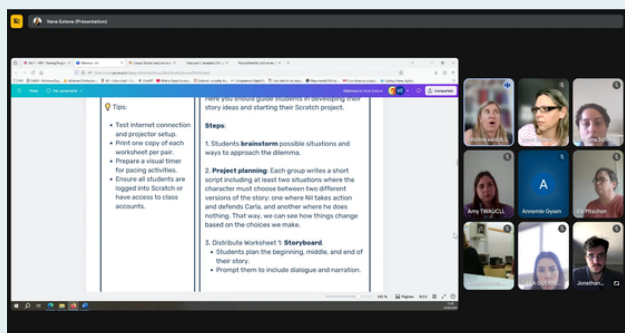
Robots Meet Arts Consortium in Action

Cross-consortium Cooperation - Workshops on Curriculum Development

On the 23rd of May, the Robots Meet Arts consortium held a **half-day workshop bringing together all partners to review and discuss the developed activities.**

The session aimed to share insights into each partner's design process: **how they imagined their activities in practice, the learning objectives they targeted, and the creative choices behind their designs.** This collaborative exchange highlighted the **diversity of perspectives within the project** — shaped by different countries, disciplines, and educational contexts. Discussions revealed how **cultural nuances, local needs, and teaching priorities** influenced activity design, sparking ideas for making the curriculum **more adaptable and inclusive.**

The workshop was a key step in **refining the curriculum**, ensuring that activities are **coherent, accessible, and relevant** for teachers across Europe.



Local Actions, Shared Goals: Partners at Work

✿ In **Greece**, students at Dimotiko Scholeio Plateos Imathias used **Edison robots** to design **recycling routes**, combining coding, storytelling, and environmental education. They reflected on **waste management, sustainability**, and how coding can solve **real-world challenges creatively.**

🚀 In **France**, the ITERrobots 2025 finale welcomed hundreds of students for a day of **robotics exploration.** The Robots Meet Arts team proposed an unplugged activity inspired by **reinforcement learning** where students simulated how robots learn through feedback, decision-making, and adaptation.

🔧 In **Greece**, the Stimuli team became **LEGO® Education Academy certified**, joining a global community of robotics educators. This certification strengthens **their ability to deliver hands-on STEAM and literacy activities**, supporting teachers with creative and inclusive learning tools.

